

Tailwind CSS Cheat Sheet

Utility-first classes for spacing, layout, color & responsiveness — style without leaving your HTML.

Utility-First

Responsive Prefixes

Flex / Grid Utilities

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1 The Core Idea

```
<!-- traditional CSS -->
<div class="card">...</div>
/* .card { padding:16px; ... } */

<!-- Tailwind: utility classes -->
<div class="p-4 rounded-lg shadow">
  ...
</div>
```

Why it's popular

No separate CSS file to maintain — small, single-purpose classes are composed directly in markup, and unused styles are purged at build time.

2 Spacing Scale (Padding / Margin)

Class	Meaning
p-4 / m-4	Padding / margin on all sides (1 unit = 0.25rem → p-4 = 1rem)
px-4 / py-2	Horizontal (x) or vertical (y) only
pt-2 pr-2 pb-2 pl-2	One side only: top / right / bottom / left
gap-4	Space between flex/grid children
space-y-4	Vertical space between stacked children

3 Layout: Flexbox & Grid

```
<div class="flex items-center
  justify-between gap-3">
  ...
</div>
```

```
<div class="grid grid-cols-3
  md:grid-cols-1 gap-4">
  ...
</div>
```

flex / grid

flex-col / flex-row

items-center

justify-between

grid-cols-N

col-span-2

4 Sizing & Display

w-full / w-1/2 / w-64

h-screen

max-w-md

min-h-screen

block / inline-block

hidden

overflow-hidden

5 Typography & Color

Typography

text-sm · text-xl · font-bold · text-center · leading-relaxed
· tracking-wide

Color (palette-color-shade)

bg-blue-500 · text-white · border-gray-200 · shades run 50
(lightest) → 900 (darkest)

6 Borders, Radius & Shadow

rounded / rounded-lg / rounded-full

border border-gray-300

shadow / shadow-md / shadow-lg

ring-2 ring-blue-400

7 Responsive Prefixes

```
<div class="text-sm md:text-base lg:text-lg">
  /* mobile-first: applies at sm, then overridden at md+, lg+ */
</div>
```

sm: ≥640px

md: ≥768px

lg: ≥1024px

xl: ≥1280px

8 State Variants

hover:bg-blue-600

focus:ring-2

disabled:opacity-50

active:scale-95

dark:bg-gray-900

 **Tip:** chain prefixes — `md:hover:bg-blue-700` applies only on medium screens and up, on hover.